CURRICULUM VITAE

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General Manager / CEO of Technology driven scale-ups and start-ups. Specialist in Artificial Intelligence with a focus on Generative AI, LLMs, and Language Technologies. Solid academic background in Computational Linguistics, and NLP (PhD completed at Harvard) to IT Industry (Indra). Skilled at connecting Technology and Business, and creating impact in different settings: (1) Guiding Clients on Digital Transformation in Financial Services (Zurich, Chubb, Hiscox), from the start-up ecosystem (Coverwallet, Clidrive, ClibrAIn), (2) Leading Transformation as an Executive (Santander, Aon) and Board Member (LLYC, Astara, Traxion), (3) Technology Evangelist at top tech events and conferences (fireside chat with Sam Altman, AWS, Salesforce, Databricks…) and Professor in Executive Education (IE). Fluent in English, French, German, and Italian. Awarded with two Horizon 2020 EU ERC Grants of + 1M€. Recognized 3 times as a Top 100 Female Leader in Spain (2016, 17, 18) and Julián Marías Prize (2017). Ranked #1 and #3 in the Choiseul 100 Economic Leaders (2018, 2019) and Top100 business creatives for Forbes (2023).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Feb 2024- **Head of Artificial Intelligence & Data for Digital Natives (Unicorns&Startups) in EMEA at Microsoft**. Leader of the **Technical Sales Specialists team** across France, Germany, Switzerland and CEMA within the sales organization (MCAPs). Sales target +100M/yr with 80% YoY growth.

2023-Jan 2024 **Cofounder and CEO at ClibrAIn.** Generative AI startup that creates language models (LLMs) and operational intelligence solutions for Spanish-speaking companies. Hired 20+ top AI talent from Research, Start-up and Big Tech (AWS, Google, Oracle, Meta). Developed LINCE, a Spanish LLM ecosystem of 40+ models generating $100k+ ARR. Key customers: UNIR (20% improvement on in student retention through Call Center analytics).

Nov2022-March 2023 **Cofounder and CEO at Clidrive.** Fintech Lending startup bootstrapped by serial entrepreneurs with 40+ employees and €4M+ revenues. Built up the team and delivered results becoming the first startup in Spain to reach €1M revenues in 3 months.

2021-2022 **Global Head of Digital for Wealth Management and Insurance at Banco Santander. Global Executive Vice-President**. Responsible for developing the Digital Strategy for Private Banking, Asset Management, and Insurance divisions at Grupo Santander, overviewing 10 countries, and transforming a business over €2.3bn. Key initiative: Data Analytics project on Multi-channel insurance sales funnel across all geographies with 10% sales increase on first pilot (Spain & Portugal).

2018-2021 **General Manager of Europe at CoverWallet, an Aon Company**, a tech startup SaaS platform to transform the Insurance distribution market for SMBs. +400 employees in US and EU and backed with $60M by Union Square, Index, Highland Capital Partners, and Two Sigma Ventures, acquired by Aon for $330M. Reporting to the CEO and part of the ExCo, led the EU expansion, managing Operations, Sales, Marketing and product, +20 direct reports. Responsible for partnership deals with Zurich and Chubb in EMEA. P&L of Switzerland, Spain, France, and UK, generating €5M+ revenue. Delivered 15% improvement in Lead conversion for Aon existing customer books after integration and 50% increase in policies sold through cross-selling. **Member of the Executive Committee of Aon Iberia** after the acquisition (2020-2021).

Sep2018- **Associate Professor at IE University** (Instituto de Empresa). IE Business School at Big Data&Business Analytics Program: "Artificial Intelligence and Language Technologies", IE HST School at Master in Computer Science and Business Technology: "Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning: Applications", Big Data Executive program for Digital Finance: "Insurtech".

2017-2018 **Head of Artificial Intelligence Product Development at Minsait (Indra).** Leading the development of an AI-based cognitive platform focused on the automated analysis and generation of language, combining Natural Language Processing, Machine Learning and Deep Learning technologies. Implemented a solution for mortgage process automation by applying AI to extracting information from BPO documents, reducing by 20% cost (FTEs) and errors in the process.

2014-2017 **Founder and CEO of LINHD** (Digital Innovation Lab & Digital Humanities) at UNED http://linhd.es, raising €1.5M in funding. Key IT projects focused on Natural Language Processing, Database Interoperability (George Eckert Institute, Germany); digital transformation projects (Spanish National Library); training programs and consulting for initiatives in LatAm. Team of 10.

2009-2017 **Associate Professor, UNED**. Elected Member of the UNED Government Board (3 years), Member of the Faculty Government Council, serving as Secretary (2.5 years)

2006-2008 **Teaching Assistant at Harvard University**, Graduate School of Arts and Sciences.

KEY BOARD MEMBERSHIPS

2024-now **Independent Board Member, Traxion (**Mexico) https://traxion.global/

2021-2024 **Independent Board Member, President of the Audit Committee and member of the Appointments and Remuneration Committee** at Llorente y Cuenca LLYC https://www.llorenteycuenca.com/

2022-2024 **Advisory Board to the CEO** of Astara (Bergé Auto, Automotive company – 8,3bn revenue) www.astara.com

2022-now **Advisory Board** at Albia Capital M&A fund, focused on industry & logistics https://albiacapital.com/

2019-now **Advisory Board** of Conexo Ventures, a VC backed by GED devoted to tech startups https://conexo.vc/#advisors

2023-now **Advisory Board** at AFI School of Finance Afi | Consultoría financiera, económica y tecnológica

2023-now **Advisory Board** at the Fintech Coinscrap Finance https://coinscrapfinance.com/

2019-now **Advisory Board** at the tech startup Lang.ai devoted to AI for language and customer service https://www.lang.ai/

2015-2021 Member of the **Scientific Advisory Board** of the EU Research Infrastructure for Language Technologies CLARIN www.clarin.eu

EDUCATION

2021 ICA-Certificate on Corporate Governance & Boards Management. https://www.iconsejeros.com/
2021 London School of Economics (LSE) - "Santander W-50 Program" Women Leadership.
2020 ESADE Business School - Executive Program for Women Executives in Spain "Promociona" with full scholarship.
2019 MIT Sloan - Executive program "Frontiers in Innovation & Entrepreneurship", sponsored by Foundation Rafael del Pino.
2014 UC3M Madrid - MA in Digital Information Systems.
2008 PhD in Philology, "Doctor Europeus". Extraordinary Prize. Finished at Harvard University (2 years as Visiting Scholar).
2004 MA in Spanish and Classics at the U. Complutense de Madrid. 1st National Prize on both.

FOREIGN LANGUAGES

SPANISH: Mother Tongue. **ENGLISH**: Fluent – C2 Proficiency level at Spanish School of Languages, TOEFL, GRE.
FRENCH: Fluent – C2 Proficiency level at Spanish School of Languages.
ITALIAN: Fluent – C2 Proficiency level at Spanish School of Languages.
GERMAN: Fluent – C2 Proficiency level at Spanish School of Languages, ÖSD Zentrale Mittelstufe Prüfung.

HONORS AND AWARDS

2024 "Laurel" Prize of Región de Murcia - top Executive of the year.
2023 Selected as one of the "Top 100 creatives in business 2023" by Forbes Spain link
2023 UU Award for "Revelation Entrepreneur" by W Startup Community.
2021 WiDS SAS Prize for Women in Machine Learning and Data Science.
2018, 19 Ranked #1 & 3 at the Choiseul Ranking 100 Economic Leaders for Tomorrow http://choiseul.es
2017,18,19 Selected as one of the Top100 Female Leaders in Spain www.lastop100.com
2019 Selected by the journal "Emprendedores" as one of the top 9 most influential Spanish entrepreneurs.
2017 Julián Marías Prize for excellent research career under 40 years old.

RESEARCH PROJECTS AND GRANTS (selection)

2016-2021 ERC Starting Grant, ERC-2015-STG-679528 POSTDATA: Financed by Horizon 2020) €1.1M.
2022-2023 ERC Proof of Concept LyrAIcs, ID964009.

INTERNATIONAL MOBILITY AND FELLOWSHIPS

Visiting Fellow and Teaching Assistant at RCC at Harvard University (MAE-AECI grant); Researcher at Queen Mary, University of London. CSIC. Research stays in Firenze, (Società Dante Alighieri), Chicago (DePaul Univ.), Romanisches Seminar der Universität Bonn. Invited Professor at CONICET (Buenos Aires); at U. Habana; at U. Pontificia Católica (Chile); at UNAM, Mexico (30 teaching hours); Eötvös Lórand U (Budapest).

PUBLICATIONS AND TALKS (SELECTION)

-Book Chapter: "Procesamiento del lenguaje natural", at Inteligencia Artificial. Guia definitiva desde los orígenes a la IA Generativa, Anaya 2025.
-Book Chapter: "Inteligencia Artificial y Lengua Española. Panorama Actual y Perspectivas", at Anuario del Instituto Cervantes 2025. https://lnkd.in/demTce8R
-Fireside chat with Sam Altman, IE University, Madrid, 23rd May 2023. Video
-Techcrunch: "Clibrain joins the generative AI race with Lince, an LLM optimized for Spanish", 12th July 2023. Link
-Wired: "Elena González-Blanco, la impulsora de la Inteligencia Artificial en español" Link. Keynote speaker at Wired 2023 Summit in CDMX.
-GenAI roundtable moderator at Databricks Data+AI World Tour, Madrid, 28th November 2013, program link
-Keynote speaker at Salesforce Innovation Days, 27th October 2023, La Granja, Segovia.
-Keynote speaker at Uber 10th year anniversary "Ciudades en movimiento", Mexico, CDMX, 14th September 2023, link
-"Status and future of GenAI" Keynote at Paradigma Open Space developers conference, Madrid, 21 October 2023. link
-"Conversatorios Casa de América RTVE - Especial Inteligencia Artificial", Madrid, 11th May 2022. Link
- Expansion. Inspirational conversations between female execs and entrepreneurs: "Which companies can Artificial Intelligence help?". Link
-Amazon Web Services Summit 2019, guest speaker invited at AWS Spain CEO Keynote, Madrid, 7th May 2019. Link
-"En el corazón de la encrucijada. Inteligencia artificial y tecnologías del lenguaje", Telos 111, 2019:
-Conference: "Artificial Intelligence: Opportunities and Challenges", American Institute of Madrid, & MIT Club of Spain, 21st January 2019.
-"Inteligencia Artificial: La Humanidad Digital", Plenary speaker, ICAI, 5th April 2018. Link
-"Retos y oportunidades de la inteligencia artificial hoy", Harvard Club of Spain&IE School of International Relations, Madrid, 27th Feb 2018.
-Author of 4 books and 51 articles. Participation in many international conferences, acting 33 times as invited speaker.

TECHNICAL KNOWLEDGE

LLMs, Cloud, Database (MySQL), Data modelling, Data analytics (Tableau, Looker, Mixpanel), Sales Automation (Salesforce), Programming Languages (Python, R), Natural Language Processing (NLTK, Spacy), Google AdWords, CRM/Marketing (Customer.io), Agile PM.
HOBBIES: Travel, sports (Pilates, paddle tennis), ballroom and Latin dance. Mother of 4 children.